

MEDIEVAL HISTORY



MODULE - 24

MUGHAL DYNASTY
AKBAR – PART 2



MUGHAL DYNASTY

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

ART AND ARCHITECTURE



- 1** During the reign of Akbar, many indigenous art styles were encouraged leading to :
 - the common use of sandstone,
 - the use of arches (mainly in a decorative form).
- 2**
 - He built the Agra fort in red sandstone.
 - His other forts are at Lahore and Allahabad.
 - He built Fatehpur Sikri (city of victory) near Agra, and a palace-cum-fort complex in it. Many buildings in Gujarati and Bengali styles are found in this complex.
- 3**
 - The most magnificent building in it is the Jama Masjid and the gateway to it is called Buland Darwaza (the Lofty Gate), the height of which is 176 ft.
 - It was built in 1572 AD to commemorate Akbar's victory over Gujarat.

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- 4 Other important buildings at Fatehpur Sikri are Jodha Bai's palace and the Panch Mahal.
- 5 Built his own tomb at Sikandra (near Agra), which was completed by Jahangir.
- 6 Built the temple of Govindadeva at Vrindavan.
- 7 Built the Jahangiri Mahal in Agra fort, according to Hindu design based on Man Mandir.
- 8 Akbar commissioned the illustrations of several literary and religious texts.
- 9 Illustrations of Persian versions of Mahabharata and Ramayana were produced in miniature form.

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ART AND ARCHITECTURE



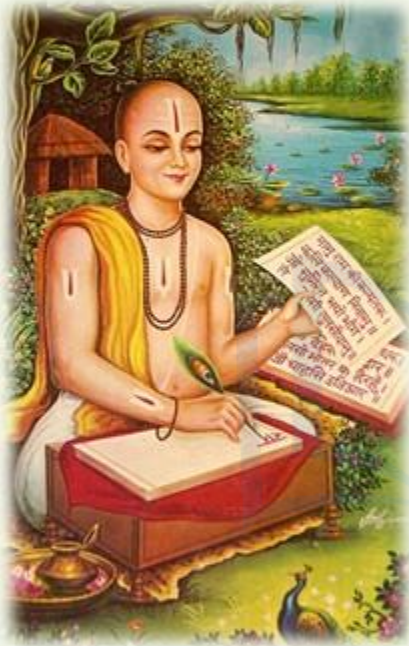
- 10** ■ Many other Indian fables became the miniature paintings in the art studio established by Akbar.
- Historical works such as the Akbar Nama also remained the main themes of Mughal paintings.

- 11** One of the most important works, Hamznama, which consisted of 1200 paintings, belonged to his reign.
- 12** He organised painting in imperial karkhanas and also introduced European style.
- 13** Indian colours such as peacock blue, Indian red began to be used.
- 14** **PROMINENT PAINTERS**
- ✓ Mir Sayyid Ali
 - ✓ Abdal Samad
 - ✓ Farukh Beg
 - ✓ Jamshed Basawan
 - ✓ Daswant (painted Razim Namah, the Persian Mahabharata).

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ART AND ARCHITECTURE



15 Persian language became widespread in the Mughal Empire by the time of Akbar's reign.

16 Important Literary Figures:

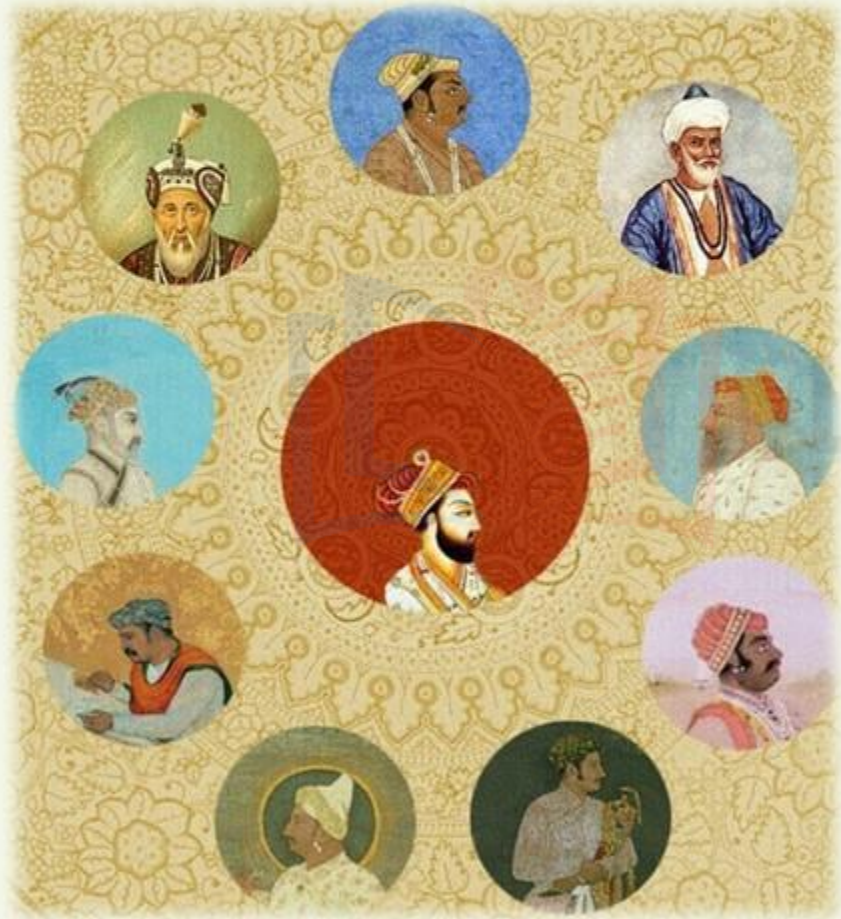
- ✓ Abul Fazl and his brother Abul Faizi,
- ✓ Abdul Qadir Badauni (who wrote Kitabul-Tawarikh),
- ✓ Khwaja Nizamuddin Ahmad Harami
- ✓ Utbi, and Naziri (leading Persian poets) were present at Akbar's court.

17 The most influential Hindi poet was Tulsidas, who wrote the Hindi version of the Ramayana, the Ramcharitmanas.

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AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

NAVRATANS OF AKBAR



1

- Akbar, was a great lover of the artists and intellectuals.
- His passion for knowledge and interest in learning from great minds attracted him to men of genius to his court.

Nine of these courtiers were known as Akbar's Navratnas (or nine jewels), these were:

- ✓ ABUL FAZL
- ✓ FAIZI
- ✓ FAKIR AZIAO DIN
- ✓ TANSEN
- ✓ RAJA BIRBAL/ MAHESH DAS
- ✓ RAJA TODAR MAL
- ✓ RAJA MAN SINGH
- ✓ ABDUL RAHIM KHAN-I-KHANAN
- ✓ MIRZA AZIZ KOKA

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

NAVRATANS OF AKBAR



1 ABUL FAZL

- Abul Fazl Wrote Ain-i-Akbari and Akbar Nama.
- He had also Lead Mughal imperial army in its wars in Deccan.
- He was murdered by Bir Singh Bundela, on the orders of Prince Salim

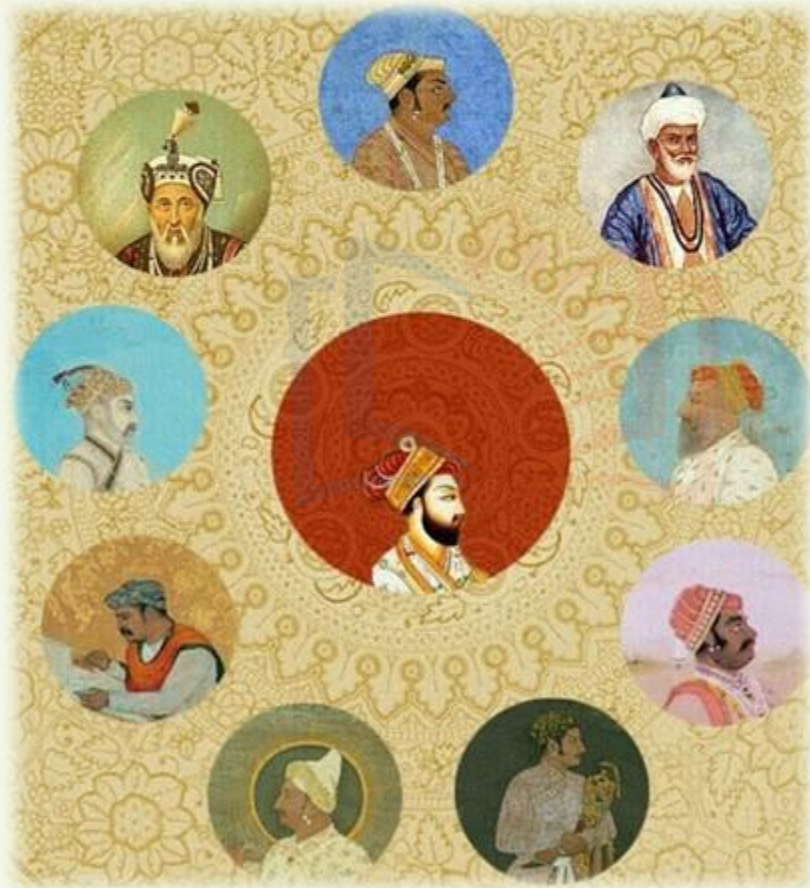
2 FAIZI

- Historian Abul Fazl's brother and Persian poet.
- He translated Lilavati into Persian (a work on mathematics)
- Under his supervision, the Mahabharata was translated into the Persian language

MUGHAL DYNASTY

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NAVRATANS OF AKBAR



3 FAKIR AZIAO DIN

He was a Sufi mystic and one of the chief advisors of Akbar.

4 TANSEN

- Great musician
- Hindu of Gwalior, served as a court musician to King Ramachandra
- It is believed that he could bring rain and fire through singing the ragas Megh Malhar and Deepak respectively

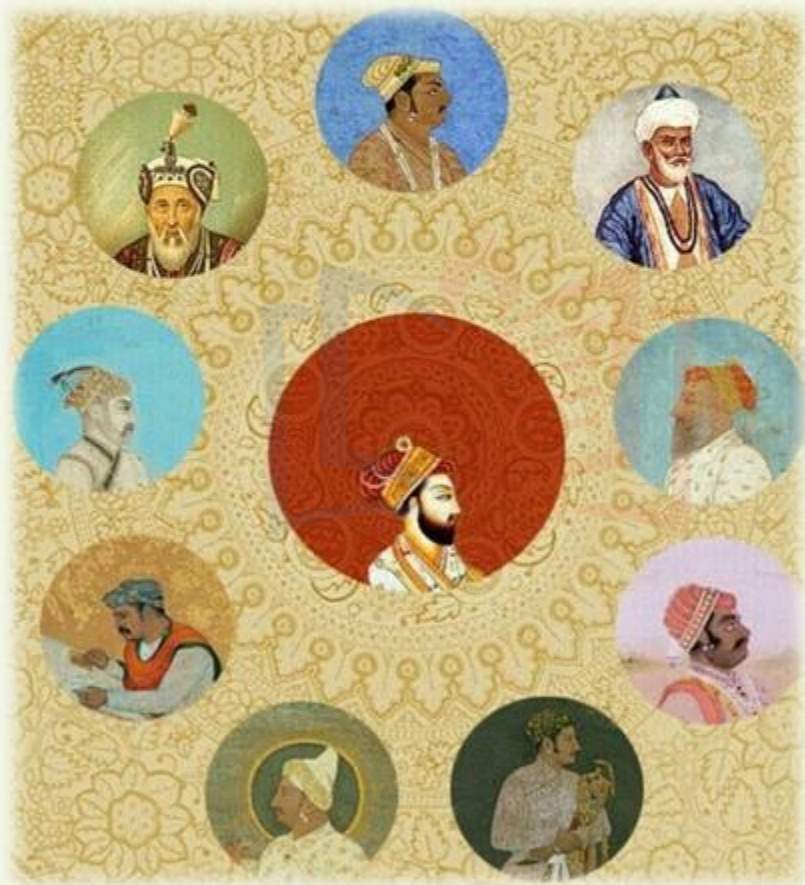
5 RAJA BIRBAL/ MAHESH DAS

- Courtier to whom Akbar gave the title of both Raja and Birbal.
- Had died fighting Yusuf Shahis on North West frontier

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6 RAJA TODAR MAL

- Finance minister, overlooked revenue system.
- Introduced standard weights and measurements
- Earlier worked under Sher Shah Suri.
- In 1582 AD, Akbar bestowed on him the title of Diwan-i-Ashraf.

7 RAJA MAN SINGH

- He was a Mansabdar, grandson of Akbar's father-in-law
- Trusted general of Akbar

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NAVRATANS OF AKBAR



8 ABDUL RAHIM KHAN-I-KHANAN

- Great poet
- Son of Bairam Khan
- Although a Muslim by birth, was a devotee of Lord Krishna.
- Translated Babarnama into Persian.

9 MIRZA AZIZ KOKA

- He was also known as Khan-i-Azam or Kotaltash and was one of the leading nobles
- He also served as the Subedar of Gujarat.

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